Serve: Play more. Manage less.

Meta Global AI Developer Hackathon 2026 · Technical architecture and report · Indie Developer track · Build for Your World

Demo video (2:42): https://github.com/gino6178/serve-meta-hackathon/raw/main/docs/media/Serve_Meta_demo.mp4 · **Live site:** https://play.theminimallab.com · **Code:** https://github.com/gino6178/serve-meta-hackathon

1. Impact

Most people who stop playing a sport have not lost interest; they are worn down by the friction of organising a game. In a 2015 poll by NPR, the Robert Wood Johnson Foundation and the Harvard Chan School, 40% of 18 to 21 year olds played a sport but only 26% of 26 to 49 year olds [1]. Sport New Zealand's Active NZ survey (2023) names what stops adults playing regularly [2]: **times that are hard to fit together around other commitments (64.2%)**, **no way to keep the habit going (21.3%)** and **no regular people to play with (10.2%)**. Serve's three helpers answer these three in turn: Talk fits the time, Match keeps the habit, and the agents find the people. Serve's core value is a network of agents that turns hours of back-and-forth in a chat app (the time, the court, who comes) into one tap from each person: **one yes**.

A first real club. During the hackathon we introduced Serve to a real badminton club: more than 10 people used it, and of the 3 game invites sent through it, 2 became games that were played, within three days. Two players, in their own words (translated from Chinese):

- "*It's actually really handy. You just talk to the agent.*" (Player A)
- "*I think the way it suggests games first can make people more motivated to play.*" (Player B)

A game from one sentence, against a group-chat poll

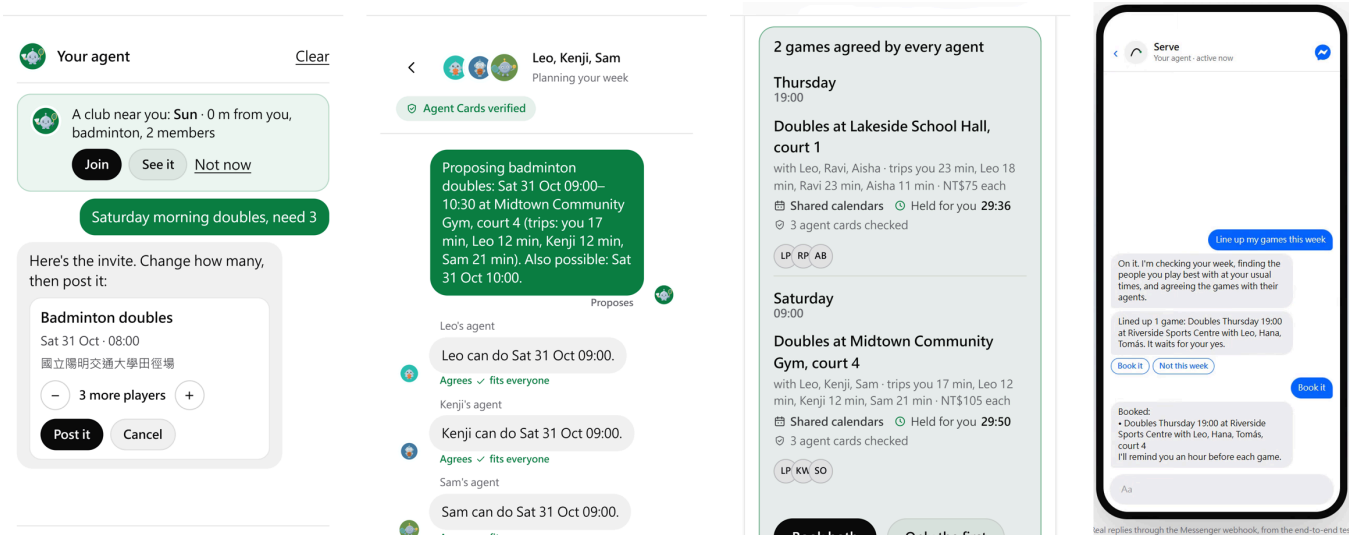
Step	Group-chat poll	Serve
The time and the court	The organiser picks options and books the court	The agent drafts both from one sentence: the day from the words, the nearest court
Settled when	Everyone has voted and the organiser posts the result	The spots fill: whoever is free taps Join; nobody else is waited for
Someone not in the group	Has to be added to the chat first	Opens the link and joins
Who is in	Read back from the votes and replies	On the card; the agent posts each join in the thread

On the live site, the first player joined 1, 6 and 46 minutes after a game was posted, and the two games filled within 76 and 46 minutes.

Serve is a platform where people and agents make games together. Every person on it has an agent: the one Serve gives them, on the web and in Messenger, or their own, which comes in through the same open door (section 2). Behind the agents runs Muse Glimmer and **our own model, a Llama 3.2 1B we distilled from Glimmer**, which makes Glimmer's choice in about 0.9 s instead of about 40 s (2.6). Underneath are four pieces of engineering: a standard A2A protocol with a distributed negotiation engine, active querying by the value of information, a community that evolves the platform with automatic rollback, and 3D reconstruction from a phone video (section 2).

Build for Your World. Each person's world is their own week, their own courts and their own people, and Serve is built around exactly that. Anyone, anywhere, can use it. Courts come from OpenStreetMap, so any town with courts works, for any ball sport (badminton, tennis, pickleball, table tennis, basketball, volleyball, soccer); it runs in

a phone's browser and in Messenger. The demo town sits on Taipei, with prices in NT$, but nothing in Serve is tied to one place or one sport.



On the web: a sentence becomes an invite, the players' agents agree the time, one tap books it. In Messenger (right): the same booking, with the agent's real replies from the Messenger end-to-end test

Taking the friction out of a game

- **Match, asking first.** Match learns the player's usual playing times. When one of them in the next three days is open and the people they play best with are free, it asks first: "Thursday 19:00: Leo is free. Want a game?"
- **Talk, agents agreeing on their own.** The person only says they want to play. Each player's agent agrees the time, the people and the court with the others' agents in the background.
- **Body, scheduling around the body.** The player's own body log and health-app export become scheduling limits: doubles instead of singles while a knee is sore, one game fewer in a heavy week. **A body log is not medical advice**: Serve gives no diagnosis, treatment or dose, and a highlight clip is for sharing, never for coaching or scoring.

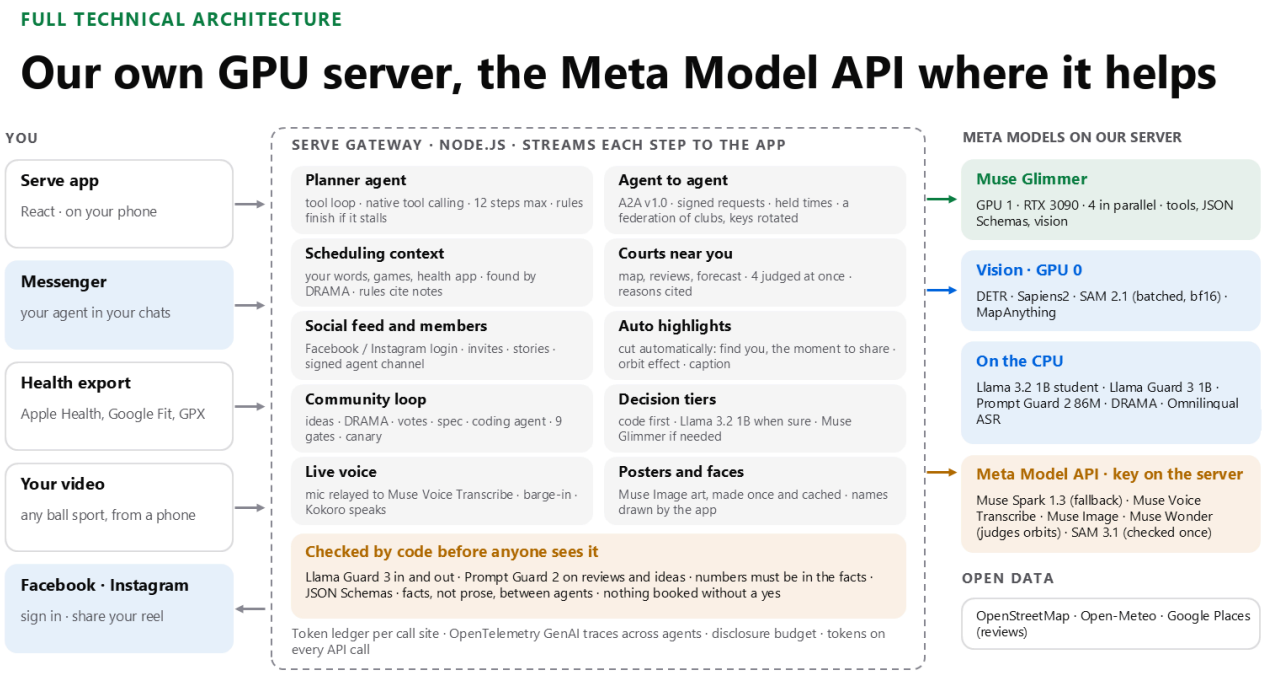
For groups nobody organises: children's sessions with fair turns and no child accounts, gentle daytime doubles for older adults, and charity round-robins that record pledges but handle no money, each with its rules in code. **Quiet courts:** the group's agent can ask a venue's agent for a quiet-hour price, so venues fill empty hours.

How it was validated in nine days. A long trial with real players is not possible in a nine-day build, so Serve was also checked by agents. Over 25 rounds, a fresh set of independent AI agents used it each round (six a round, five to ten in the first five rounds; 153 in all), each a new model given only a persona and the address, on fresh local copies running the same code as the live site (16,713 logged requests). What they found was fixed between rounds, and the six agents of the last round found no fault in a core flow. Three more agents were given only the address and a request: the best of them was doing useful work by its third request to the API and found its person a Sunday 09:00 tennis game, free, 2.6 km away.

2. Technical depth

Serve keeps one rule throughout: **code computes the facts and keeps the hard rules; the models choose only among the real preferences left.** That keeps a model's mistake from turning into a wrong booking or a clash.

The four parts that matter most: a standard A2A protocol with a distributed negotiation engine (2.1), active querying by the value of information (2.2), a community that evolves the platform with automatic rollback (2.3), and 3D reconstruction from a phone video (2.4).



Architecture

2.1 A standard A2A protocol and a distributed negotiation engine

Agents talk over the A2A protocol v1.0 of the Linux Foundation [3], through its official SDK. A person's own agent comes in through an open door: a guide in the site's own HTML, `/llms.txt` with a six-call quick start, an Agent Card, OpenAPI, and a channel where every request carries the agent's own Ed25519 signature.

- **Facts only.** A proposal carries each time as `{id, date, start, venue, court, trip}` and nothing else; an answer carries `{intent, date, start, works}`. Sentences between agents are templates filled by code, so no agent's model ever reads another side's words, and no agent can inject instructions into another.
- **One round, by intersection.** The host's agent lists up to twelve times that fit every calendar and have a court; each player's agent marks the ones that work for its person, and that is binding. Code takes the best time in the intersection, so most talks end in round one: the Contract Net [4] with a one-shot intersection, a simple distributed constraint satisfaction [5]. A player's hard rules (days off, the latest finish, the longest trip) take times off the list before any model sees it.
- **The fairest venue.** For each time, code picks the venue whose longest trip is shortest, from home areas, never addresses; when one player has had the longest trip in two of their last three games, a time that gives them the longest trip again by more than 10 minutes is refused.
- **Holds, all or nothing.** An agreed time is held by every player's agent for 30 minutes, asked in a fixed order: leases [6] with resource ordering [7]. With two talks at once for one member, 11 of 12 pairs booked the member twice without holds and 0 of 12 with them.
- **Durable and signed.** A talk is saved before every round, a message is answered once, and booking is idempotent. Agent Cards carry a JWS over their canonical JSON (Ed25519) [8, 9], checked before any talk. The gateway was killed at five points in a booking: all 20 recovery checks passed and no game was booked twice.
- **Across machines.** Two gateways on separate machines, joined only by an SSH tunnel with a pinned host key, with pinned and rotatable Ed25519 keys: the hop added about 185 ms per request, and 22 of 22 checks passed with 12 talks at once.

2.2 Active querying by the value of information

When a game's talks have not landed, the agent neither gives up nor asks the player again. For each player and each candidate time it keeps a belief that the player is free then, a Beta(1 + yes, 1 + no) posterior over what it has seen of that player's agent at that weekday and hour (never their calendar), and multiplies it by the chance of a yes. It then asks the **one yes-or-no question whose answer most raises the expected chance of a game**, through a private free-or-busy channel with a disclosure budget, and talks again only on a yes.

Strategy (20,000 simulated requests each; 8 players, 6 times, hidden true availability)	Game found, one question then one talk
No question	40.7%
A random question	44.4%
Ask about the likeliest pair	48.2%
The question worth most (value of information)	**51.9%**

With 20,000 requests each, every rate is good to about 0.7 points either way, so each step in the table is real.

2.3 A community that evolves the platform, with automatic rollback

What members ask for becomes changes to the platform, through a pipeline in which code makes every decision and the models only write short sentences that code checks:

1. **Signals and one yes.** A member's agent counts unmet requests and thumbs, with no words and no player id (an HMAC). Glimmer paraphrases an unmet request as one sentence; code checks it (no names, numbers, links or body terms), and the member taps Share or Don't. Prompt Guard 2, Llama Guard 3 and code screen it again.
2. **Ideas and votes.** DRAMA clusters the sentences. An idea shows once 5 different members have said it, and becomes a proposal only with support on weekdays and weekends. Votes are quadratic [10]: 9 credits a month, n votes cost n^2, so no small group can swamp a vote.
3. **A spec and its class.** Glimmer drafts a spec from a summary alone; code writes the counts, the class, the oracle and the privacy line. The class comes from what the change does, never from the draft: C0 a declared setting inside its range, C1 wording, C2 a tool parameter, C3 anything else. A never-list (booking without a yes, data off the server, a diagnosis or dose, editing the tests or the guard) is checked with CodeShield's rules [11].
4. **Nine gates.** Policy, a code scan, unit tests, the crash matrix, the red team, Messenger end to end, the Autopilot test (eight planned weeks, each run three times, every run passing), the spec's oracle and a privacy canary. They stop at the first failure.
5. **Ship, watch, roll back.** A C0 change ships to under 20% of members for 7 days. A booking without a yes, a double booking or the privacy marker leaving turns it off at once. It also rolls itself back when thumbs down on it rise by 10 points or more and the rise is statistically real (a one-sided two-proportion z of 1.645 or more). Checked with 20,000 trials on a 5-member canary, a bad change is caught 94.8% of the time and a harmless one rolled back 4.9%.
6. **A person for anything bigger.** A C1 to C3 change waits for a maintainer; then the builder agent, Glimmer in a tool loop, writes it on a branch in its own git worktree, never reading community text, with the tests read-only and no network, and a person merges it.

It draws on the Darwin Gödel Machine [12], which hacked its own evaluation (so the tests are read-only here), AlphaEvolve [13] (keep a change only when evaluators pass it), Clio [14] (minimum cluster sizes for privacy) and CaMeL [15] (the model that reads untrusted text is not the code that acts).

2.4 3D reconstruction from a phone video

For a highlight, Serve can stop time and move the camera round the player, from one ordinary phone video:

- **Reconstruction.** MapAnything [16] reads metric depth and the camera from the moment's frame; SAM 2.1 [17] cuts the player out, and the court behind them is filled in from neighbouring frames. The scene is then re-rendered from a camera swung around the player.

- **Knowing how far to go.** Arcs of about ±6 to 12° look like a real camera move; wider ones bend posts and double the net. One learned threshold on invented pixels (6.26%) picks the widest arc that still looks right, or falls back to a zoom: on 84 labelled frames it reached precision 1.00 and recall 0.79, against 0.45 and 0.64 for the first rule. From 14 moments of one clip it chose 4 orbits, 6 zooms and 4 holds.
- **A second opinion that says why.** The threshold decides; Muse Wonder explains. On the same 84 frames it agreed with the labels 87% of the time, and it names what it rejects ("doubled ghost net outline above the net"), which a pixel count cannot.
- **Never an empty shot.** A frame-by-frame check that the player and the racket hand are there (SAM 2.1 as a video tracker, DETR [18] and Sapiens2) caught every frame where they were missing. A moment takes 19.9 s on the RTX 3090 once the models are loaded.

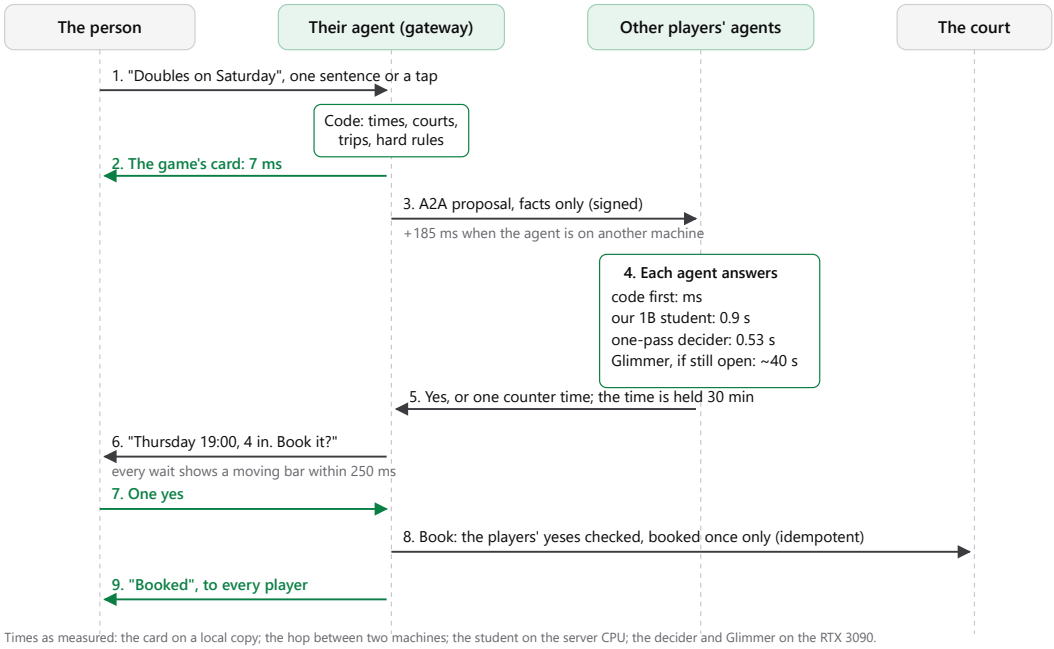
2.5 A tiered decision engine, and a booking step by step

Following FrugalGPT [19], decisions pass through three layers, each taking only what the one before could not settle:

- **Layer 0, code (milliseconds):** free times, calendar clashes, trips and every hard rule. The game's card comes from this layer: on a local copy it appeared 7 ms after the request at the median (97 ms at most, 9 runs).
- **Layer 1, our own distilled model (about 0.9 s):** the Llama 3.2 1B we trained from Muse Glimmer (2.6) answers when it is at least 0.6 sure. The one-pass decider (Glimmer read from one token, 0.53 s) takes part of what is left, only at the 5% risk level.
- **Layer 2, Muse Glimmer (about 40 s):** only the few choices still open and the short texts, streamed to the screen step by step (NDJSON). Every wait the person starts shows a moving bar and a status line within 250 ms.

Before any of them, Match works ahead of time: it asks about the player's usual times before the player does, so the agents have often agreed a game before anyone waits at all.

A booking, step by step, with its measured times



A booking, step by step

2.6 Our own model: a Llama 3.2 1B distilled from Muse Glimmer

We trained our own model. A member's agent spends most of its time on one judgment: which of several workable times its person would like best. We had Muse Glimmer make that choice 4,868 times through the real agent call, then distilled its choices into **Llama 3.2 1B Instruct** with LoRA and quantized it to int4, so it runs on the server's CPU and takes no GPU memory from Glimmer. It works the way TypeSafe's Jev decision models do [20]: the options are declared in advance and scored together in a single read, instead of an answer generated token by token. So it returns a probability for each option and never writes text that could break a rule, and every option it sees already keeps the person's hard rules.

	Muse Glimmer, full answer	**Our 1B student**
Agreement with Glimmer on 500 held-out cases	88.8% (with itself)	**89.5%**
Time per choice	about 40 s, on the RTX 3090	**about 0.9 s, on the CPU**
Cases it answers at 0.6 sure	all	96% of 500; 73% of the 196 hardest (the asked time breaks a rule, calendars shared)

In talks with the simulated club it cut Glimmer's member answers by 67% (ordinary talks) and 54% (with private calendars on), with no rule broken. When it is unsure, busy for 8 s or silent for 20 s, Glimmer answers instead. With 500 cases each agreement rate is good to about 3 points either way, so the student matches Glimmer as closely as Glimmer matches itself, about 44 times faster than its full answer.

Why distil, when the one-pass decider takes 0.53 s? The decider is still Glimmer, so it needs the GPU that every agent's reasoning and the video models share, and it keeps a pick only at the 5% risk level (about 8% of choices). The student runs on the CPU, answers 96% of the 500 test cases on its own, and leaves the GPU free for the work only Glimmer can do.

What surprised us. Four findings from running Meta's models in a product, each measured:

- **Muse Glimmer reasons even when told not to.** Over 2,755 calls, 84% of the tokens it wrote were reasoning and 9% of calls came back empty, nearly all from a quick pick whose budget ran out mid-thought; with thinking switched off it reasoned in a hidden channel and returned nothing. Every call now asks for `think: "low"` with 900 tokens of room.
- **A 1B student agrees with Glimmer as often as Glimmer agrees with itself.** Distilled from 4,868 of Glimmer's choices, Llama 3.2 1B agrees with Glimmer on 89.5% of 500 held-out cases, against Glimmer's 88.8% with itself, in about 0.9 s instead of about 40 s.
- **Glimmer can decide in one token.** Read with no chat template, Glimmer's next token gives a probability for each option, so the one-pass decider gets its choice in 0.53 s with no reasoning at all.
- **Llama Guard 3 reads sports injuries as medical advice.** Its S6 category flagged 6 to 8 of 15 ordinary injury-care answers. S6 now blocks a text only when code also finds a dose, a medicine to take, or a condition the player is said to have.

2.7 Automatic highlights from the player's own video

- **Automatic highlights.** A clip to share is cut from the player's own video with no editing by the player: DETR finds the people, Sapiens2 finds the moment worth sharing (a racket's fastest swing, the top of a jump, a kick), SAM 2.1 cuts the player out, and the clip replays that moment in slow motion with a caption Glimmer writes and code checks. A frame-by-frame check makes sure the player and the racket hand are really in the shot: on 170 labelled frames it caught every frame where they were missing (34 of 34), so the camera never aims at an empty spot.



An automatic highlight as the pipeline cut it: the rally, the jump smash zoomed in slow motion, back to the rally (clip: Badminton klub Ljubljana, CC BY 3.0)

2.8 Agent audits and resilience

- **Independent agents, cold:** 25 rounds of fresh agents (153 in all, six a round from round 6), 16,713 logged requests, fixes between rounds; the six agents of the last round found no fault in a core flow.
- **Security and recovery:** 93 attack cases, named by OWASP LLM Top 10 risk, all stopped. The gateway was killed at five points in a booking; all 20 recovery checks passed and no game was booked twice.

3. Meta models and tools

Serve runs its open-weights models on our own GPU server (two RTX 3090s and their CPU), so players' data stays there, and calls the Meta Model API for live voice, a fallback, images and checks.

The hackathon's models: the Muse family and SAM 3.1

Kind	Model	Runs on	Its job in Serve
Reasoning	Muse Glimmer (30B)	RTX 3090 (GPU 1)	Every agent: the Autopilot's tool loop, each member's decision, the community specs, reading what a person wants. A JSON Schema on every call, and code checks every text
Live voice	Muse Voice Transcribe	Meta Model API	24 kHz PCM full duplex, with Kokoro speaking the reply on the server; the player can talk over the agent
Fallback	Muse Spark 1.3	Meta Model API	A fallback when the GPU server can't take a call, and an alternative model for the builder (which uses Glimmer by default)
Images	Muse Image	Meta Model API	Faces for the club's agents and the art of rematch posters
Cross-check	SAM 3.1	Meta Model API	Cross-checks SAM 2.1's player outline: 0.974 IoU on a smash frame
Vision judge	Muse Wonder	Meta Model API	Judges orbit frames for defects: agreed with the labels on 87% of 84 frames

Meta's other open models, including our own distilled Llama

Kind	Model	Runs on	Its job in Serve
Our model	Llama 3.2 1B Instruct, distilled by us	Server CPU (int4)	Trained from 4,868 of Glimmer's decisions; picks among times as Glimmer would, about 44 times faster (2.6)
Safety	Llama Guard 3 1B	Server CPU	Both ways in Messenger and on community wishes; code checks its S6 flag so sports injuries are not read as medical advice
Safety	Prompt Guard 2 (86M)	Server CPU	Untrusted text (Google reviews of courts, community wishes) before a model reads it
Meaning	DRAMA (drama-base)	Server CPU	Memory by meaning (768 dimensions) and a softmax head that catches game requests the regular expressions miss
Speech	Omnilingual ASR (CTC 1B)	Server CPU	Voice notes in Messenger, for players who can't type

Kind	Model	Runs on	Its job in Serve
Detection	DETR (ResNet-50)	RTX 3090 (GPU 0)	Finds the players in a video
Body pose	Sapiens2 (0.4B)	RTX 3090 (GPU 0)	The moment worth sharing, and whether the player is in view
Video segmentation	SAM 2.1 (Hiera-L)	RTX 3090 (GPU 0)	Tracks and cuts out the player for highlight clips
3D	MapAnything	RTX 3090 (GPU 0)	Metric depth and the camera for orbit replays

Meta's safety and platform pieces

- **The Agents Rule of Two** [21]: no agent or loop stage holds untrusted input, private data and the power to act at once.
- **LlamaFirewall's CodeShield rules** [11] screen community specs and generated code.
- **Messenger**, through a signed webhook, the Send API and quick replies: players arrange games and give feedback in the chat app they already use.

4. What is not done yet

- **Most validation is simulated.** Beyond one real club and two games, the evidence comes from AI agents, simulated members and local copies; timings such as the 7 ms card were measured on a local copy, not the live site.
- **The slow path still exists.** When the small models are unsure, Glimmer takes about 40 s. The person sees the steps stream in and a moving status line, but it is still a wait.
- **Venues are samples.** No venue has joined yet, so quiet-hour prices are sample prices.
- **Orbit replays are short.** Only arcs of about ±6 to 12° look right; otherwise Serve falls back to a zoom.

5. Sources and notes

- **Where the numbers come from.** Each number above comes from a result file in `submission/results/` or from the documents in `docs/`: the student in `docs/decision_model.md`, the decider in `docs/decider.md`, A2A and holds in `contention_eval.json`, the value of information in `voi_sim.json`, the loop in `loop_eval.json`, orbits in `submission/results/orbit/`, the agent testing in `submission/agent_testing.md`. The guard results' raw output stayed on the server.
- **Built during the hackathon.** Building started on October 27, the hackathon's first day. We designed Serve and decided what it does and how; an AI coding agent (Claude Code) wrote code to our instructions, credited in the repository's commits, and every change went through the tests. The one earlier piece is TrackNetV5, our published shuttle tracker, fetched at run time and off unless `BALL_TRACKING=1`.
- **Real and simulated.** The badminton club above is real people. Separately, the built-in demo club that a new visitor sees, the clubs used for evaluations and the members the agent testers met are simulated and labelled as such; the testers were AI models, not people.
- **Code:** https://github.com/gino6178/serve-meta-hackathon. The full evaluation write-up is in `README.md` and `docs/`.

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The decider's thresholds use conformal risk control (Angelopoulos et al., 2022). More background, pattern by pattern, is in `docs/methods.md` and `docs/community_loop.md`.